SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #16 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“Love is shown through things.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In some homes, gifts were the main way love was spoken. A parent who worked long hours may have shown care by providing, buying, and fixing, and may have found it hard to say the words. Or a parent who could not afford much may have felt like a failure. Children can learn that love equals what you give or get, and adults can then measure affection by price tags, or feel unloved when the gifts stop.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors generosity, and giving can truly be a way of loving. But Paul says that even if I give all I possess to the poor, but have not love, I gain nothing. John says let us love not in word and speech, but in action and truth. Proverbs says that a dish of vegetables where there is love is better than a fattened ox with hatred. Love often includes gifts, but it is shown most deeply through time, presence, honesty, and faithfulness.

> *“If I give all I possess to the poor and exult in the surrender of my body, but have not love, I gain nothing”* (1 Corinthians 13:3).

Also see

> “Little children, let us love not in word and speech, but in action and truth” (1 John 3:18).

> “Better a dish of vegetables where there is love than a fattened ox with hatred” (Proverbs 15:17).

> “Be devoted to one another in brotherly love. Outdo yourselves in honoring one another” (Romans 12:10).

> “Better a dry morsel in quietness than a house full of feasting with strife” (Proverbs 17:1).

Common self-statements

- If they really loved me, they would buy me this.
- I show my kids I love them by giving them things.
- Without gifts, I do not know how to show care.
- When money is tight, I cannot be a good parent or spouse.
- Gifts prove love.
- No present means no love.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Feeling loved only when gifts arrive and concluding that love is gifts.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing love is either expensive or absent.
- Mind reading: Assuming that someone’s lack of gifts means they do not care.
- Magnification: Treating a missing gift as proof of missing love.

Challenging questions

- How did my family show love, and with what?
- What else did love look like in my home besides gifts?
- What do I wish I had received besides things?

- How do I try to show love now, and does it match what people need?
- What does it cost people when love is shown only through money?
- What is one way I can show love this week that costs nothing?

Truth summary

> Gifts can be an expression of love, but they are not the same thing as love. Love is also time, words, presence, and faithfulness. I can receive and give love in ways that do not depend on what money can buy.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, General
- Giving
- Gifts, Physical/Material
- Love, For Others
- Parenting

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Parenting

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Love Take Me Over — Steven Curtis Chapman
Receiving God's love can shape loving action instead of fear or performance.

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Love is shown through things"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Love is shown through things." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How did my family show love?
- ☐ What did I want besides gifts?
- ☐ How do I show love now?
- ☐ What does the person I love need?
- ☐ What is one free way to show love today?
- ☐ Where have I measured love by things?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Gifts are one expression of love, not the whole of it.
- ☐ Time and presence are gifts.
- ☐ I can say "I love you" in words.
- ☐ I do not need to buy love.
- ☐ I am loved even when I have little to give.
- ☐ God's love is not measured in things.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Corinthians 13:3
  "If I give all I possess to the poor and exult in the surrender of my body, but have not love, I gain nothing."
- ☐ 1 John 3:18
  "Little children, let us love not in word and speech, but in action and truth."
- ☐ Proverbs 15:17
  "Better a dish of vegetables where there is love than a fattened ox with hatred."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ How love showed up: Each day, write one way you gave or received love that did not cost money.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, 1 John 3:18 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I can love in action and truth, with time and words as well as gifts.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Love, General" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ List five ways love has been shown to you. Circle the ones that did not involve money.
- ☐ Give one gift of time. Spend an hour with someone with no phone and no purchase.
- ☐ Say it out loud. Tell someone close to you, in words, what you appreciate about them.
- ☐ Ask a question. Ask someone you love, "How do you feel most cared for?" and listen.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Love is shown through things": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Love without a price tag
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Love is shown through things.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, thank You for loving me without a price tag. Heal what I learned about love and things. Teach me to give and receive love through time, truth, and faithfulness. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #17 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“People like us never get ahead.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This message can be spoken or silent. It may have come from a family that worked hard and still struggled, from a neighborhood with few opportunities, or from a parent trying to protect children from disappointment by lowering expectations. “People like us” can be about income, race, region, education, or family history. It often passes down as a kind of loyalty: to dream bigger feels like leaving the family behind.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says that God raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the ash heap. Paul tells us not to be conformed to this world but to be transformed by the renewing of our minds. The Bible honors diligent hands, and it also says that we can do all things through Christ who gives us strength. None of these verses promises wealth, and none denies that obstacles are real. They say that our family’s past is not the final word on what God can do with us.

> *“Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God”* (Romans 12:2).

Also see

> “He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the ash heap. He seats them among princes and bestows on them a throne of honor. For the foundations of the earth are the LORD’s, and upon them He has set the world” (1 Samuel 2:8).

> “He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the dump” (Psalm 113:7).

> “Idle hands make one poor, but diligent hands bring wealth” (Proverbs 10:4).

> “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

Common self-statements

- Nothing ever changes for people like us.
- It is not worth trying.
- Wanting more is being ungrateful.
- If I get ahead, I am leaving my family behind.
- The deck is stacked against us.
- We are who we are.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Turning my family’s experience into a rule about everyone like us.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that effort will not pay off.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that I either stay where I am or betray my roots.
- Fatalism: Treating a family pattern as a fixed destiny.

Challenging questions

- Who first said “people like us,” and what were they trying to protect?
- Do I know anyone from a background like mine who did move ahead? How?
- What real obstacles do I face, and what is within my control?
- What does it mean to be loyal to my family without being limited by their expectations?
- What would I try if I believed God had a future for me?
- What is one small step I could take toward a goal?

Truth summary

> My family’s story matters, but it is not my ceiling. Obstacles can be real, and God can open doors I cannot yet see. I can honor where I came from and still take steps toward growth.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Trust
- Plans
- Strength
- Faith

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Unemployment
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Glorious Unfolding — Steven Curtis Chapman
God’s story continues beyond a painful or confusing chapter.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God’s renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

More Than Conquerors — Steven Curtis Chapman
Christ’s saving work answers condemnation, shame, and fear of separation from God.

Victory in Jesus — Joy Gardner, Cynthia Clawson, Mike Allen and Reggie Smith
This classic gospel hymn celebrates Christ’s rescue and the hope of life with Him.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People like us never get ahead"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People like us never get ahead." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who first said "people like us"?
- ☐ What were they protecting?
- ☐ Who has moved ahead from a background like mine?
- ☐ What real obstacle do I face?
- ☐ What small step could I take?
- ☐ How can I honor my family and still grow?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My family's past is not my final word.
- ☐ God raises people from the dust.
- ☐ I can honor my roots and still grow.
- ☐ Obstacles are real, and so is God's help.
- ☐ Small steps can change a direction.
- ☐ I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Romans 12:2**
  "Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind. Then you will be able to test and approve what is the good, pleasing, and perfect will of God."
- ☐ **1 Samuel 2:8**
  "He raises the poor from the dust and lifts the needy from the ash heap. He seats them among princes and bestows on them a throne of honor. For the foundations of the earth are the LORD's, and upon them He has set the world."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:13**
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] One step ahead: Each week, write one step you took toward a goal and what you learned.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 12:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God can renew my mind, so my family's story is not my ceiling.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Plans" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Name the message. Write the "people like us" sentence you heard and who said it.
- [ ] Find one example. Learn the story of one person from a similar background who moved forward and note what helped.
- [ ] Set one small goal. Choose something specific to do in the next month, such as a class, a certificate, or a conversation.
- [ ] Tell your family what you are doing. Share your goal kindly so growth does not feel like leaving them.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People like us never get ahead": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A step ahead
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People like us never get ahead.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You lift the poor from the dust. Free me from the sentence that says people like me never get ahead. Help me honor my family, take wise steps, and trust You with my future. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #18 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“People like us don't go to college.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

In some families, no one has gone to college, or college was something others did. Cost, fear of debt, a lack of information, a parent who feared losing a child to a different world, or a school that did not encourage it can all feed this belief. It can also be quiet: nobody forbade it, but nobody planned for it either. Many capable people never ask because they assume the door is not for them.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors wisdom and learning in many forms: the craftsman, the farmer, the scholar, the shepherd, and the merchant. Proverbs says wisdom is supreme, so acquire wisdom, and the heart of the discerning acquires knowledge. James says that if any of us lacks wisdom, we may ask God, who gives generously without finding fault. Paul tells us to work at whatever we do with our whole being, for the Lord. College is not the only path, and it is not for everyone, but the belief that “people like us” cannot learn or train further is not from God.

> *“Wisdom is supreme; so acquire wisdom. And whatever you may acquire, gain understanding”* (Proverbs 4:7).

Also see

> “The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge, and the ear of the wise seeks it out” (Proverbs 18:15).

> “Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him” (James 1:5).

> “Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men” (Colossians 3:23).

> “I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength” (Philippians 4:13).

Common self-statements

- College is for other people.
- We cannot afford it, so there is no point looking.
- I am not smart enough.
- If I go, I will not fit in.
- My family would not understand.
- It is better not to hope.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that I would fail or not belong.
- Overgeneralizing: Treating my family’s history as a rule for me.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring evidence of my ability and effort.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing college as the only path to learning or the only path I cannot take.

Challenging questions

- Who in my family or community told me this, and what experiences were behind it?
- What do I actually know about training options, costs, and aid?

- What have I learned or mastered already that shows I can learn?
- What kinds of training or schooling might fit my gifts?
- What would I try if I knew I could handle it?
- Who could I ask for information this month?

Truth summary

> God gives wisdom generously, and learning is open to people from every background. College may or may not be my path, but I can find out for myself instead of letting an old sentence decide. There are many good ways to grow, and I can take the next step with help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Wisdom
- Intelligence
- Guidance
- Seeking
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Speak O Lord — Keith and Kristyn Getty
Receive God's Word with humility and allow truth to reshape thought and action.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

To God Be the Glory — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn celebrates redemption and forgiveness through Christ.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People like us don't go to college"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People like us don't go to college." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who told me college is not for me?
- ☐ What do I actually know about my options?
- ☐ What have I already learned to do well?
- ☐ What would I try if I knew I could?
- ☐ Who could I ask for information?
- ☐ What is one question I can ask this month?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I can ask God for wisdom.
- ☐ Learning is for people like me, too.
- ☐ My ability is not decided by my family's history.
- ☐ There are many paths to training and growth.
- ☐ Asking questions is not presumptuous.
- ☐ I can start with one conversation.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 4:7**
  "Wisdom is supreme; so acquire wisdom. And whatever you may acquire, gain understanding."
- ☐ **James 1:5**
  "Now if any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him."
- ☐ **Colossians 3:23**
  "Whatever you do, work at it with your whole being, for the Lord and not for men."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I learned about my options: Each week, write one new fact you found about training, schooling, or funding.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, James 1:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God gives wisdom generously, so I can ask about my next step in learning.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write what you have learned. List skills and subjects you have mastered, in work, home, church, or school.
- [ ] Gather facts. Visit a community college, trade program, or counselor and ask about costs and aid.
- [ ] Talk with someone who has done it. Ask a person from a similar background about their experience.
- [ ] Share the plan. Tell your family what you are exploring so they can be part of it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People like us don't go to college": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A fact about my options
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People like us don't go to college.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You give wisdom to those who ask. Free me from the idea that learning is not for me. Show me the path that fits my gifts and give me courage to ask the first question. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #19 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“Money is what causes all our fights.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Money can feel like the center of family conflict, especially when it was scarce or when arguments about it were loud. Children who grew up hearing fights over bills may link money and conflict for life. Adults can bring this into marriage, so that every disagreement is blamed on money, or so that money is avoided to keep peace.

What Scripture teaches

Money is often a place where deeper things show up: fear, control, pride, hurt, and unmet needs. James asks what causes conflicts and quarrels, and answers that they come from the passions at war within us. Proverbs says a gentle answer turns away wrath, and that a dry morsel in quietness is better than a house full of feasting with strife. Paul tells us to bear with one another and forgive, as the Lord forgave us. Money is a real stress, but it is rarely the whole story of a fight.

> *“What causes conflicts and quarrels among you? Don’t they come from the passions at war within you?”* (James 4:1).

Also see

> “A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger” (Proverbs 15:1).

> “‘Be angry, yet do not sin.’ Do not let the sun set upon your anger” (Ephesians 4:26).

> “Better a dry morsel in quietness than a house full of feasting with strife” (Proverbs 17:1).

> “Bear with one another and forgive any complaint you may have against someone else. Forgive as the Lord forgave you” (Colossians 3:13).

Common self-statements

- If we had more money, we would not fight.
- Money is the only thing we argue about.
- It is safer not to talk about money.
- Every argument comes back to money.
- We cannot fix this until we are wealthy.
- Money ruins everything.

Common logical errors

- Oversimplification: Blaming one cause for every conflict.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing the problem is either money or nothing.
- Avoidance: Skipping the money conversation to avoid a fight.
- Magnification: Making money the villain and overlooking hurt and fear.

Challenging questions

- What are we actually afraid of when we argue about money?
- Which fights are about money and which are about feeling heard or respected?

- How did money and conflict go together in the home I grew up in?
- What do we do well when we talk about money?
- What rules for a calm money talk could we agree on?
- Who could help us talk about this, such as a counselor or pastor?

Truth summary

> Money is a real pressure, but it is not the only cause of our fights. Underneath may be fear, hurt, control, or feeling unheard. We can learn to talk about money gently, name what we feel, and ask for help when we are stuck.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anger
- Communication
- Marriage
- Forgive
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anger
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Forgiveness — Matthew West
Ask God for help releasing resentment while working through real hurt.

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Money is what causes all our fights"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Money is what causes all our fights." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What am I really afraid of in these fights?
- ☐ What is under the money argument?
- ☐ How did my family fight about money?
- ☐ What ground rules could help?
- ☐ What gentle opening could I use?
- ☐ Who could help us?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Money is a pressure, not the whole problem.
- ☐ A gentle answer turns away wrath.
- ☐ Peace can be practiced.
- ☐ I can name my fear instead of attacking.
- ☐ We can set rules for hard conversations.
- ☐ Help is available when we are stuck.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ James 4:1
  "What causes conflicts and quarrels among you? Don't they come from the passions at war within you?"
- ☐ Proverbs 15:1
  "A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger."
- ☐ Colossians 3:13
  "Bear with one another and forgive any complaint you may have against someone else. Forgive as the Lord forgave you."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Fight or feeling: After a disagreement, write what it was about on the surface and what you felt underneath.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Proverbs 15:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "A gentle answer turns away wrath, so I can speak softly about money.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Communication" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- ☐ Name the deeper fear. Write what you are really afraid of when money comes up.
- ☐ Set ground rules. Agree on a time, a length, and a no-interruption rule for money talks.
- ☐ Start with a gentle opening. Practice a sentence such as, "I want us to be on the same side with this."
- ☐ Get support. If fights keep repeating, consider a pastor, counselor, or couples program.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Money is what causes all our fights": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A calm conversation
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Money is what causes all our fights.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know the fights that have shaped our home. Heal the hurt under the arguments. Give us gentle words, honest hearts, and a willingness to forgive and to ask for help. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #20 · FAMILY MONEY MESSAGES

“Wealthy people can't be trusted.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many of us learned this from a boss who underpaid us, a landlord who ignored repairs, a family who felt looked down on, or a community that felt used. Stories and media can add to it. Real unfairness exists, so the belief grows from something true. But when it becomes a rule about every wealthy person, it can block friendships, jobs, mentors, and even our own ability to prosper without guilt.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture warns about the dangers of riches and the injustice of those who oppress the poor. It also tells us that the rich and the poor have this in common: the Lord is Maker of them all. Job was blameless and upright and was also very wealthy. Zacchaeus, a rich man, gave half his possessions to the poor and was welcomed by Jesus. James says not to show favoritism, and Paul tells the rich to be generous and ready to share. Trust is measured by character, not by bank balance.

> *“The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all”* (Proverbs 22:2).

Also see

> “There was a man in the land of Uz whose name was Job. And this man was blameless and upright, fearing God and shunning evil” (Job 1:1).

> “But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, ‘Look, Lord, half of my possessions I give to the poor, and if I have cheated anyone, I will repay it fourfold.’” (Luke 19:8).

> “Instruct them to do good, to be rich in good works, and to be generous and ready to share” (1 Timothy 6:18).

> “My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism” (James 2:1).

Common self-statements

- Rich people got there by cheating.
- They look down on people like me.
- They will always put money first.
- I cannot be friends with someone who has that much.
- If I become wealthy, I will become like them.
- Wealth corrupts everyone.

Common logical errors

- Stereotyping: Treating every wealthy person as the same.
- Overgeneralizing: Turning a few hurtful experiences into a rule.
- Mind reading: Assuming that I know what a wealthy person thinks of me.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that people are either poor and good or rich and bad.

Challenging questions

- Whom did I learn this from, and what actually happened?

- Do I know any wealthy people who are honest and kind? What do I know about them?
- Do I know any poor people who have been unfair or unkind? What does that show?
- What does Scripture say about how to judge a person?
- How does this belief affect my opportunities or my own view of success?
- What would it look like to treat people as individuals?

Truth summary

> Some wealthy people have wronged others, and so have some poor people. Wealth does not decide whether a person is trustworthy. God made us all, and He looks at character and the heart. I can be wise, set boundaries where needed, and still treat each person as an individual.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prejudice
- Judgmental
- Riches, Beware of
- Trust
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Judgmental
- Money/Riches

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Our God — Chris Tomlin
God's greatness challenges helplessness before evil or hardship.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Wealthy people can't be trusted"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Wealthy people can't be trusted." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn this?
- ☐ What actually happened?
- ☐ Who does not fit this belief?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about judging people?
- ☐ How does this belief affect me?
- ☐ How can I judge people one at a time?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The rich and the poor are both made by God.
- ☐ Character matters more than a bank balance.
- ☐ I can be wise without stereotyping.
- ☐ Real injustice deserves real concern.
- ☐ I can prosper and stay generous.
- ☐ I can judge people one at a time.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 22:2**
  "The rich and the poor have this in common: The LORD is Maker of them all."
- ☐ **Luke 19:8**
  "But Zacchaeus stood up and said to the Lord, 'Look, Lord, half of my possessions I give to the poor, and if I have cheated anyone, I will repay it fourfold.'"
- ☐ **James 2:1**
  "My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Individuals, not categories: Each week, note one person who did not fit a stereotype you held, and what you saw.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 22:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God made the rich and the poor, so I can look at character, not just a bank balance.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Prejudice" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- ☐ List the experiences. Write down what happened to you or your family and what you learned.
- ☐ Find a counter-example. Learn about a wealthy person known for integrity and generosity.
- ☐ Practice individual judgment. Next time you meet someone, notice their actions before you assign a category.
- ☐ Define your own wealth. Write what generous, trustworthy success would look like for you.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Wealthy people can't be trusted": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A person, not a category
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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Thu		
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Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Wealthy people can't be trusted.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You are Maker of the rich and the poor. Heal what has been done to me and my family, and keep me from judging others by their bank balance. Give me wisdom to see character and a heart that stays generous. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.